

Crisis (IPC Phase 3)-aligned outcomes persist due to the delayed rainy season

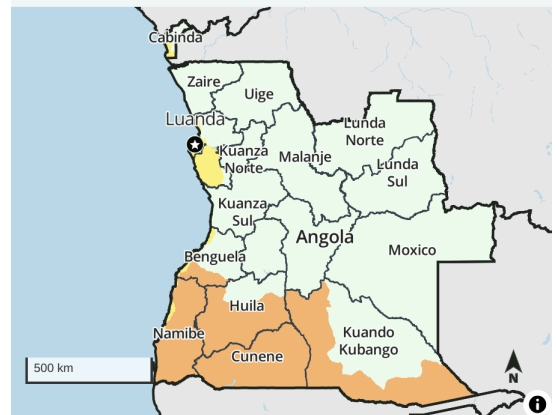
Key Messages

- Stressed (IPC Phase 2)-aligned outcomes are expected in Cunene, Huila, Namibe, and Kuando Kubango in August and September.** Following the 2025/26 below-average rainfall that degraded pasture and reduced water availability, pastoral households are resorting to selling livestock at depressed prices, further eroding income amid high food prices and an early decline in food stocks. Households are expected to meet their minimum food requirements, but not essential non-food needs (e.g., health care and school fees). **From October through January 2027, Crisis (IPC Phase 3)-aligned outcomes are expected due to early food stock depletion and deteriorating livestock-to-cereal terms of trade.** Households will rely more heavily on charcoal and livestock sales, take out high-interest grain loans, and reduce meal frequency. Pockets of the poorest households will face Emergency (IPC Phase 4)-aligned outcomes, as they resort to selling livestock assets and consuming seed stocks amid large food consumption gaps.
- El Niño-driven delay of the 2026/27 rainy season onset and below-average rainfall will worsen** lean season conditions in southern agropastoral areas from November-January. Extended moisture deficits will delay crop planting and suppress *ganho-ganho* (rural agricultural labor opportunities). Livestock body conditions are not expected to improve due to persistent forage and water deficits, keeping cattle prices depressed at 150,000 AOA (163 USD) per head in parts of Cunene. The livestock-to-maize meal terms of trade will continue to deteriorate, particularly in Cunene, as the price of one head of cattle can purchase only 150-175 kilograms (kg) of *fuba* (maize meal), compared with 500-550 kg *fuba* for a healthy steer in Huila.
- National fuel shortages and fuel subsidy cuts since July are driving high fuel prices and transportation costs and increasing informal fuel market activity.** Rising transportation costs, particularly along trade corridors connecting central and southern Angola, are amplifying existing upward pressure on *fuba* prices in Cunene. Thus, prices are expected to reach 1,000-1,150 AOA (1.09-1.25 USD)/kg by January 2027, representing a 30-35 percent increase compared to the same period last year and triple the five-year lean season average.

Projected area-level acute food insecurity outcomes, August - September 2026



Projected area-level acute food insecurity outcomes, October 2026 - January 2027



IPC 3.1-aligned acute food insecurity classification

Classifications are evidence-based but some types of evidence required for IPC-compatibility were not available

Sub-national level data

Transparency indicates classifications are IPC-aligned but not IPC-compatible

1: Minimal 3: Crisis 5: Famine
2: Stressed 4: Emergency

Symbols

! Would likely be at least one phase worse without current or planned humanitarian food assistance

For this report, FEWS NET classification is IPC-aligned. IPC-aligned analysis is evidence-based but some types of evidence required for IPC-compatibility were not available. For more information on IPC-compatibility, see endnotes.

Source: FEWS NET

This report provides an update to the [June 2026 to January 2027 Food Security Outlook](#) and [July 2026 Key Message Update](#). The analysis is based on information available as of August 15, 2026.



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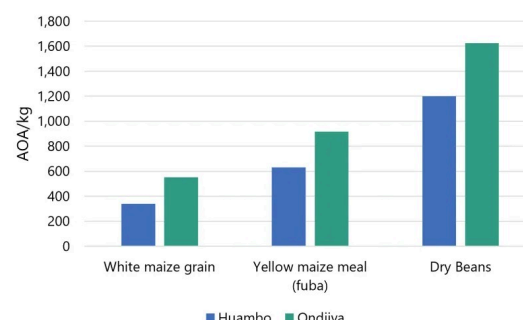
Current anomalies in food security conditions as of August 2026

- **Fuel shortages and high fuel price premiums are disrupting transportation and driving up food prices.**

Angola is an oil-producing country but depends on imports for 70 percent of its refined petroleum products. In early August 2026, the **Ministry of Mineral Resources, Petroleum, and Gas** and Sonangol, Angola's state-run oil producer, officially confirmed widespread domestic fuel shortages due to Sonangol's severe financial constraints, foreign exchange liquidity shortages, and rising global refined oil prices. The lack of fuel and recent cuts in government fuel subsidies have forced many Angolans to rely on the informal market to procure fuel rather than lower-cost formal gas stations, which receive government subsidies but frequently run out of supply during shortages. Fuel sold through informal channels typically costs three to four times more than official pump prices, with diesel and gasoline prices reaching approximately 350 percent and 400 percent above official market rates, respectively. Currently, diesel is priced at 1,500 AOA (1.63 USD) per liter and gasoline at 1,200 AOA (1.31 USD) per liter on the informal market, according to key informants. The fuel crisis has severely disrupted transportation, particularly in central and southern Angola, and has increased transportation costs along primary supply corridors connecting central surplus grain hubs like Huambo to areas of southern Angola reliant on food produced elsewhere, significantly increasing food distribution costs and **food prices**.

Figure 1

Retail commodity price comparison (August 2026) in Huambo and Cunene



Source: FEWS NET from National Institute of Statistics (INE) data

- **Staple food prices are high compared to August 2025, particularly in southern Angola, as food stocks deplete, market supply declines, and transport costs increase ahead of the lean season.** Markets in southern regions are experiencing a below-average supply as fuel shortages disrupt commercial inflows from central surplus-producing zones. Consequently, Cunene records the highest food prices nationally, whereas Huambo, a primary grain production hub in the central highlands, has the lowest (Figure 1). According to key informants, retail prices in Ondjiva (Cunene) for *fuba de milho* (yellow maize meal) reached 850-980 AOA (0.93-1.07 USD)/kg, up approximately 35 percent from 650-720 AOA/kg in August 2025. Dry beans reached 1,500-1,750 AOA (1.63-1.85 USD)/kg, up from 1,100-1,300 AOA (1.20-1.42 USD)/kg in the same period last year.
- **Atypically early seasonal pasture degradation and water depletion in southern pastoral zones have severely reduced livestock value.** In southern pastoral and agropastoral areas, deteriorating rangeland conditions since May have resulted in worsening livestock body conditions. In Cunene (Ondjiva, Curoca), farm-gate cattle prices have plummeted by over 60 percent compared to the 2023 baseline (approximately 400,000 AOA/head) as pastoralists engage in early livestock distress sales to clear herds before more severe forage deficits set in. Consequently, cattle-to-cereal terms of trade have severely eroded in parts of southern Angola. In Cunene, cattle were only selling for 150,000 AOA (163 USD) per head as of August 2026, sufficient to buy only 150-175 kg of *fuba* per weakened cow, compared to 500-550 kg of *fuba* for a healthy head of cattle in Huíla.
- **The government social safety net program Kwenda is providing regular cash transfers to eligible poor households in rural and urban areas.** The program targets 1.6 million households and provides 66,000 AOA per household quarterly. While the transfer provides financial support to poor households, its fixed nominal value has been significantly eroded by rising food prices, limiting its impact.

Humanitarian food assistance

No large-scale emergency food assistance programs are currently active. However, **Congolese refugees** from the **Democratic Republic of Congo** in the Lóvuia camp in Lunda Norte receive monthly food assistance, but this assistance has limited impact on food security in the area.

Updates to key assumptions about atypical food security conditions through February 2027

Most of the assumptions that underpinned FEWS NET's analysis of the most likely scenario for the [Angola Food Security Outlook from June 2026 to January 2027](#) remain valid; however, the following updates have been made to incorporate new evidence:

- **Severe domestic fuel shortages and elevated transport costs will sustain upward pressure on retail food prices in structural deficit-producing regions of Cunene and Kuando Kubango through late 2026.** Countrywide fuel supply disruptions are expected to drive domestic transport costs by 20-30 percent above 2025 levels through late 2026. While Sonangol projects that fuel supplies will stabilize in the near term, elevated informal transport costs continue to inflate market distribution expenses across Angola. These systemic supply chain pressures will likely continue to disproportionately impact structural deficit regions, particularly southern pastoral and agropastoral zones, which rely on long-distance commercial grain inflows from central surplus-producing hubs during the November 2026-February 2027 lean season.
- **Delayed onset of the 2026/27 rainy season and below-normal cumulative rainfall, driven by strong El Niño, are expected across southern Angola from October and beyond January 2027.** In northern Angola, seasonal rains are likely to start on time and be above average. In central Angola, rainfall is expected to start on time and be average, though a high risk of extreme variability, either above- or well below-average precipitation, remains. Persistent root zone soil moisture deficits will continue in northwestern Angola through at least November.
- **Constrained agricultural labor demand and elevated underemployment will reduce household purchasing power through February 2027.** According to the Angolan National Institute of Statistics (INE)'s [Q2 2026 Employment Survey](#), the informal sector remains the main source of employment, accounting for 80.1 percent, while rural underemployment stands at 6.4 percent, more than triple the 2.0 percent unemployment rate in urban areas. As the lean season approaches, agricultural labor opportunities are expected to decline, driven by delayed rainfall postponing land preparation and by the financial constraints of better-off households who are scaling back area planted, suppressing labor demand.
- **Below-average fertilizer use, particularly among poor smallholder farmers in southern agropastoral areas, is expected as the Ministry of Agriculture and Forestry (MINAGRIF) transitions from free distribution of inputs to subsidized prices for 90,000 metric tons of fertilizer and seeds.** Households still recovering from 2025/26 crop failures will face severe difficulties meeting the required upfront costs of obtaining inputs, reducing area planted and potentially crop yields for rainfed agricultural seasons.
- **Staple food prices across southern reference markets will experience steep seasonal inflation through the peak of the lean season.** Retail *fuba* and grain prices across southern reference markets, such as Ondjiva and Lubango, will rise sharply between September 2026 and January 2027. Grain prices in Ondjiva are expected to peak between 1,000 and 1,150 AOA (1.09 and 1.25 USD)/kg at the height of the lean season in January 2027, according to key informants.
- **Severe water and forage deficits in southern pastoral zones will force distress livestock sales and negatively impact pastoral income.** Water and forage availability in Cunene, Namibe, and southern Huíla will continue to deteriorate until the effective onset of seasonal rains in November/December. Livestock body conditions will reach seasonal lows in October/November, triggering distress sales of small ruminants and cattle, further depressing livestock prices and eroding pastoral purchasing power.

Humanitarian food assistance

No emergency humanitarian food assistance operations are planned, funded, or likely in high-concern southern provinces (Cunene, Huíla, Namibe, and Kuando Kubango) through January 2027. While localized [WFP](#) commodity vouchers and [UNICEF](#) and Angolan government therapeutic feeding programs target acutely malnourished children in select southern municipalities, these interventions provide specialized nutrition support rather than full-ration household food assistance.

Projected acute food insecurity outcomes through January 2027

In southern agropastoral and pastoral areas of Cunene, Huíla, Namibe, and Kuando Kubango, Stressed (IPC Phase 2)-aligned outcomes are expected from August to September 2026. Poor households are rapidly depleting their food stocks due to the below-average 2025/26 harvest, forcing atypically early market reliance for food. These households are meeting their food needs from remaining food stocks and generating limited income through petty trade and casual labor, including charcoal production and sales, firewood collection along transit corridors, agricultural land clearing and field preparation, domestic labor, and water transport. However, income generated from these activities covers only food consumption needs and is insufficient for non-food essentials. **From October 2026 through January 2027, Crisis (IPC Phase 3)-aligned outcomes are expected** in these regions as the lean season peaks. Poor households will likely deplete their food stocks, forcing them to rely heavily on market purchases amid high staple food prices. Additionally, a strong El Niño is expected to delay the onset of the agricultural season, which typically begins in October, and to drive below-average rainfall, reducing agricultural labor opportunities and severely depressing livestock prices. Poor households will intensify coping mechanisms, including taking out [high-interest grain loans](#) (*cantineiros*), selling non-breeding livestock, and reducing adult meal portions to prioritize feeding children. A subset of poor households lacking livestock or the capacity to engage in informal labor will resort to more erosive coping strategies, such as selling their last female breeding livestock or consuming saved seed stocks to address large food gaps. These households will face **Emergency (IPC Phase 4)-aligned outcomes**.

Stressed (IPC Phase 2)-aligned outcomes are expected to persist throughout the projection period in the coastal fishing zones and urban and peri-urban areas, including Luanda, Benguela, and Cabinda. Low-income urban households spend over 65 percent of their income on food and face high food prices driven by poor macroeconomic conditions, including high inflation, high fuel prices, and rising transport costs. Households will adjust by shifting dietary preferences toward cheaper staples (cassava flour), cutting non-food expenditures, and using Kwenda social safety net cash transfers to buffer consumption gaps. In coastal Namibe, reliance on shore-based artisanal fishing, marine foraging, and trade in dried fish will only generate enough income to cover minimum food, but not essential non-food, needs.

Populations in the central highland surplus-producing zones, including Huambo, Bié, and Kuanza Sul, are expected to maintain **Minimal (IPC Phase 1)-aligned outcomes** through January 2027. Substantial household grain reserves from the 2025/26 main harvest, supplemented by ongoing horticultural income and crop sales, will ensure adequate food access. These zones will likely maintain typical seasonal consumption patterns without resorting to negative coping strategies, buffering households against national fuel-driven food price inflation.

Annex 1: Updates to events that would likely change projected acute food insecurity outcomes

*While FEWS NET's projections are considered the "most likely" scenario, there is always a **degree of uncertainty** in the assumptions that underpin the scenario. This means food security conditions and their impacts on acute food security may evolve differently than projected. FEWS NET issues monthly updates to its projections, but decision-makers need advance information about this uncertainty and an explanation of why things may turn out differently than projected. As such, the final step in FEWS NET's scenario development process is to briefly identify key events that would result in a **credible alternative scenario** and significantly change the projected outcomes. FEWS NET only considers scenarios that have a reasonable chance of occurrence.*

National

Longer than projected delay in the onset of the 2026/27 rainy season

Likely impact on acute food insecurity outcomes: If the onset of the main seasonal rains is delayed beyond late November across southern and central Angola, agricultural labor opportunities will collapse during the peak of the lean season, preventing recovery of the seasonal green harvest in February 2027. Pastoral transhumance will extend longer than is typical, increasing livestock mortality and further deteriorating livestock terms of trade. This would lead to a higher proportion of agropastoral households in Cunene, Huíla, and Namibe experiencing Emergency (IPC Phase 4)-aligned outcomes.

Protracted fuel supply disruption lasting beyond October 2026

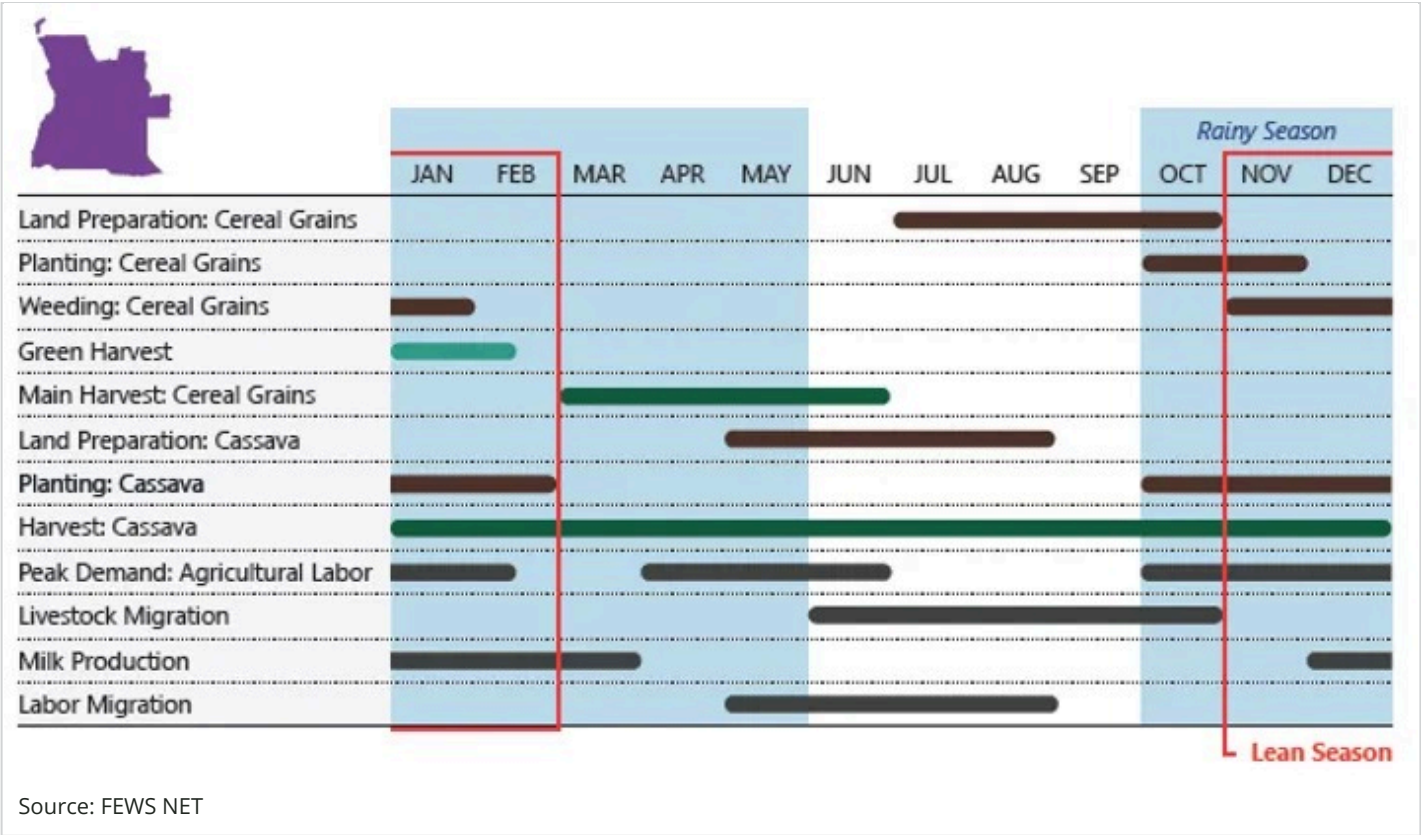
Likely impact on acute food insecurity outcomes: If fuel shortages persist into Q4 of 2026, the cost of delivering goods from central surplus-producing hubs to southern deficit-producing markets will increase by over 50 percent. Market supply in Ondjiva and Lubango will drop sharply, driving staple prices to record highs and resulting in Emergency (IPC Phase 4)-aligned outcomes for the southern provinces. High urban transport costs would also push poor peri-urban households in Luanda and Benguela from Stressed (IPC Phase 2)-aligned outcomes into Crisis (IPC Phase 3)-aligned outcomes.

Annex 2: Updates to key sources of evidence used in this analysis

Many of the key sources of evidence utilized for FEWS NET's [June 2026 to January 2027 Food Security Outlook](#) remain the same; however, new and additional sources of evidence are listed below.

Evidence	Source	Data format	Food security element of analysis
Livelihoods profiles	FEWS NET	Qualitative	Typical sources of food and income by livelihood zone
National Fuel Supply Official Declaration	Ministry of Mineral Resources, Petroleum, and Gas/Sonangol (August 2026)	Official Communiqué/ Policy Statement	Macroeconomic shocks, fuel distribution bottlenecks, and domestic transport costs
Agricultural Input Campaign 2026/27 Strategy	Ministry of Agriculture and Forestry (MINAGRIF) (August 2026)	Policy briefing & supply statistics	Fertilizer availability (90,000 MT), input co-payment policy, and planting expectations
Kwenda Cash Transfer Implementation Reports	FAS/World Bank (ICR & PAD 2024–2026)	Programmatic monitoring reports & impact evaluations	Social safety net coverage, transfer values, and household food consumption expenditure
Emergency Food & Nutrition Relief Updates	WFP/UNICEF/FAO Angola	Operational updates & situation reports	Humanitarian food assistance coverage, commodity voucher distribution, and Severe Acute Malnutrition therapeutic treatment
Staple Food and Livestock Market Price Monitoring	FEWS NET/Field Trader Surveys (August 2026)	Quantitative price series (AOA/kg, AOA/head)	Retail food prices, livestock farm gate prices, and cattle-to-cereal terms of trade

Annex 3: Seasonal calendar



Recommended citation: FEWS NET. Angola Food Security Outlook Update August 2026 - January 2027: Crisis (IPC Phase 3)-aligned outcomes persist due to the delayed rainy season, 2026.

* FEWS NET classification is [IPC](#)-compatible with limited exceptions. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. In rare cases, FEWS NET classification is IPC-aligned but not IPC-compatible. IPC-aligned analysis is evidence-based but some types of evidence required for IPC-compatibility were not available.

Food Security Outlook Update

This Food Security Outlook Update provides an analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography over the next six months. Learn more [here](#).